

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 46

VIRGINIA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Virginia's family courts and child-welfare system.

154

VIRGINIA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 289
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 22 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 16, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
69 OF 133

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · VIRGINIA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Virginia. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

John Whitbeck

ATTORNEY · LOUDOUN COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"John Whitbeck claimed to have an understanding of DV/coercive control and its impact on divorce and custody cases. He did not do anything to protect me and my children from our abuser and instead caused us more harm by angrily advising me I had to "just let things go" and "be the bigger person" which ended up with me being verbally and emotionally abused by my ex spouse. The firm is poorly run and the attorneys are unnecessarily arrogant, rude and demeaning."* POWHATAN

> *"Is literal drinking bunnies with plowman and Fisher and my attorneys the Graham law firm and Miriam Ibrahimi both owned by John Whitbeck."*

> *"Opposing counsel"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/va-john-whitbeck/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Robert Louis Harrison, Jr

JUDGE · BEDFORD · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Decided the case before I stepped foot in the court room. Entertains all false allegations if they're made by the mother in the case. Dad is guilty until proven innocent. Even the local attorneys call this fraud a squirrel and don't know what to expect when they step into his court room. He doesn't listen. Manipulates CS guideline calculations to maximize support obligations with zero evidence to support the claims. Suppressed evidence at the first trial. Didn't provide clear order at the second. Mother's interpretation of the written order provided her more time. After a motion to rehear, it became evident the judges intent was to increase my time, as 50/50 was granted but the judge has dismissed 3 motions to amend child support since then and manipulated numbers each time to dismiss as "insufficient" change. Guy was indicted on wire fraud charges prior to presiding over J&DR when he was an attorney for a grant related to a local but national memorial. Paid his way out of jail. No surprise he's out to collect IV D funding if it means falsifying guideline calculations to do so."*

> *"Was called a gatekeeping dumbass + charged with contempt for not giving my parenting time to my abuser (who harasses me daily for MY court ordered time with the kids). ZERO accountability for men. Judge Harrison engaged in conduct raising serious due process concerns, including hostile courtroom behavior, profanity toward mom, and repeated contempt proceedings based on allegations contradicted by documented evidence. Made disparaging remarks on the record and issued a contempt ruling over a custody time dispute, despite the time being explicitly granted to me under the standing court order."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/va-robert-louis-harrison-jr/complaint-packet
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Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

VIRGINIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 154 Virginia families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
289
152 of 154 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$151,650
median across 59 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
22
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
64.3%
99 of 154 who answered; 60 of 154 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
154	1.9	152 of 154	69

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Virginia families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF VIRGINIA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	92	$25,500	$55,136	$5,072,510
Lost Wages	63	$15,000	$172,884	$10,891,699
Other Court Fees	44	$2,100	$5,572	$245,170
Therapy / Evaluations	54	$2,500	$21,613	$1,167,110
Reunification Services	34	$150	$3,104	$105,520
GAL Fees	49	$2,000	$12,971	$635,557
Asset Loss [1]	47	$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (59 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$151,650	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	22	1.8 yrs
Mean months lost	32	2.7 yrs
Total across all families	3,673	306.1 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · VIRGINIA

Most families documenting in Virginia are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	69	45%
Case closed: within last 2 years	23	15%
Not provided	21	14%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	14	9%
Not in court but still affected	12	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	74	48%
Family Court Only	58	38%
Unknown	11	7%
CPS Only	9	6%
False Allegations / Coached Claims	1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	49	32%
5 – 10 years	33	22%
3 – 5 years	31	20%
Over 10 years	16	11%
6 months – 1 year	12	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	50	32%
Visitation Only	43	28%
50/50 Joint	22	14%
Children in Foster Care	15	10%
Full Custody	14	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Bedford	8	6%
Virginia Beach	7	5%
Chesterfield	6	5%
Prince William	6	5%
Fairfax	5	4%
Loudoun	4	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	44	29%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	35	23%
High Conflict Divorce	17	11%
Other	15	10%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)	10	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — VIRGINIA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Virginia comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *The CPS, foster parents, GAL, judges and attorneys worked together to get my rights terminated. They admit that I did not abused my kids yet they terminated my rights. I am a victim of domestic violence they used that against me. The foster parents alienated my children*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

This system has ripped me away from my child with no evidence presented other than the childs father's word.

— VIRGINIA PARENT · SAMANTHA

MORE VOICES FROM VIRGINIA

The system has destroyed a sacred primary attachment bond between two children and their mother. Words cannot even describe what was stolen from us.

— CYRENE

The system has assasinated my character and has allowed false and unproven accusations. Perjury by other parent and her family friend Sarah King (CPS)

— RALPH

The system and their systemic abuse has completely ended my family and all aspects of my normal life. Not only has it taken my once super close children but it has rendered false titles against me such as fugitive and criminal. It has cost me my family, freedom, job, and good [...]

— HAYLEY

Completely destroyed our lives, we lost everything and are still fighting tooth and nail to get it back but it's been made incredibly difficult.

— SIDNEY

The system has traumatized, alienated, drained us financially and emotionally, caused my son PTSD, and attempted to destroy us. They have appointed GALs that did not do what they are required by state law, not included us in any of the investigation, been bias, making [...]

— (DEMETRICE) INEZ

Completely and utterly destroyed me my kids and all of our hopes, dreams, milestones, and moments. They stole everything from us.

— ERIC

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *It's destroyed the Fabric of innocence for Children and Families in a Country that's supposed to protect it.*
>
> — RAMON

It conspired and obliterated my family unit and took my sources of funding on deceipt, lies, conspiracy to defraud, and no proof, just words alone, and changing a lens of false misrepresentations to change a view of reality.

— KRISTIN

Tore my kids away from me, even though I was the present parent for 15 years. The GAL never once came and spoke to me, but visited my exes house.

— MICHELLE

Complete destroyed a happy family. Turned family members and some of my children against me by providing a false narrative of me and who I am. Belittled me as a mother

— MICHELLE

This system tore my family apart. It damaged my mental health more than it's ever been. It was a traumatic experience to have my children ripped away from me and separated from each other and then parentally alienated by social services, foster parents and other custodians.

— MICHELLE

Family law in Loudoun county is corrupt and unjust and cost myself and my children any and all financial stability.

— KAREN

Systemic corruption with GAL program, bias/non-neutrality/withholding material changes and sexual abuse disclosure from court/failure to investigate, I could literally go on

— KELLY

It has completely destroyed our entire lives. My long standing business of over 40 years was forced to shut down. We became homeless with no help. My other children are psychologically damaged by severing their bond with their sister.

— ELECTRA

Family court ripped my family apart. My child went from a loving family to being abused and miserable. Her smile that was once bright and happy has been stripped for tears and a hard frown. I keep asking, how is it I had her all her life and there was never an issue but now I'm [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Hey, it ripped us apart. Manipulating my kids to turn against me.Also separated my children two and one home to another with no visitation for the siblings*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

She has destroyed my children's safety and security to avoid acknowledging she made a mistake.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely traumatized and separated us. We are at rock bottom and the system doesn't care. Kids are traumatized but they don't care they blame us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost everything bc of a gal or who was unfair. And a court system who didn't care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my family, caused ultimate distrust in the Judicial System. This Judge tried to destroy my good name and character as a public figure and as an Ordained Minister. Has taken my grandsons away from me and my family, we have been totally alienated feom both by grandsons [...]

— MINISTER CHERYL

It has absolutely wrecked and ruined my kids and our family. We all might as well be DEAD.

— ANNA

I asked for a divorce so that I could get at least half of my house or half of my children or half of my 401(k) or half of my car or half of my motorcycle instead they took everything now I'm homeless carless I work at 9 to 5 and I haven't seen my kids since I met Mr. Whitbeck.

— JOHN

For the past six years, my life has been a nightmare, watching my kids, being psychologically abused as I expended all my financial resources, time and energy to protect them. The system destroyed the lives of my kids for their own financial gain and they do not protect victims [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has robbed my youngest son the chance to grow up with his older brother and the system violated my rights and ignored the UCCJEA

— ALISON

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They have hurt my children and myself putting my babies in a horrible situation with physical abuse , sexual abuse separated my twins and alienated them from whole family where they were safe and loved*
>
> — APREAL

Due to false allegations, I lost my house, car, child, and freedom in less than 10 minutes.

— MICHAEL

Broke my children right caused them mental abuse and caused them years of trauma. Broke my constitutional right caused me trauma. Helped the other party to to cause them mental and physical abuse. Both of my children have been put in situations that have caused them mental and [...]

— KATHRYN

Emotional abuse in a time of need . Destroyed my family and home and myself every joy in my wonderful life is gone. They killed my soul and I'm alone in the world completely..

— AARAH

My sister lost her children for staying in an abusive relationship. I lost mine for leaving. As women, there was no path that led to protection.

— SARA

The corruption in our judicial system cost me the ability to provide the life my children deserved on a regular basis and often the loss of stable, structured, nurturing time together. My experience is minor compared to many others, yet it matters and is an indicator of a huge [...]

— VALARIE

Mentally destroyed a child. He will never recover from being taken away from his Mom and 4 years old and given to a Dad that physically and mentally abused him.

— MCKENZIE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This system has destroyed the loving relationship with our son. Also they have caused my son serious trauma and us severe trauma, that i know is going to take years to heal from. And quite literally changed the coarse of my family for the worst.*
>
> — KASSIDY

Used mothers false allegations to extort money from me at the cost of my love for my child.

— JAMIE

Setup on false charges and stole our children without cause just to lie to turn our children against us while. They are paid to do that exact thing very well .

— DUSTIN

This system has failed my young daughter and myself, “time always tells the truth” a has clearly proven that corruption is prominent and rampant. This system has proven that is it more profitable to be unlawful and corrupt vs upholding or practicing lawfully to protect children [...]

— EARL

We have been incredibly traumatized and devastated by what has occurred over the past 2 1/2 years. We miss our children and the moments we’re being prohibited from sharing with them every single day.

— WHITNEY

Inflicted lifelong trauma and distrust of the system

— KIMBERLY

Destroyed my relationship with both of my sons went from four days weekly sometimes five to 0 literally all for a check and bitterness all rights where violated

— CHRIS

Destroyed me financially, caused defamation of my status as a mother, caused me to develop cptsd, anxiety and more. Same for my child.

— JULIE

Shattered my dreams of motherhood.

— LARESHEA

97 Virginia parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — VIRGINIA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Virginia families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> The CPS, foster parents, GAL, judges and attorneys worked together to get my rights terminated. They admit that I did not abused my kids yet they terminated my rights. I am a victim of domestic violence they used that against me. The foster parents alienated my children
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> — RALPH

> The system and their systemic abuse has completely ended my family and all aspects of my normal life. Not only has it taken my once super close children but it has rendered false titles against me such as fugitive and criminal. It has cost me my family, freedom, job, and good name. I wake up everyday reaching for my children they fraudulently took from me two years ago on July 8, 2024.
>
> — HAYLEY

> Completely destroyed our lives, we lost everything and are still fighting tooth and nail to get it back but it's been made incredibly difficult.
>
> — SIDNEY

> The system has traumatized, alienated, drained us financially and emotionally, caused my son PTSD, and attempted to destroy us. They have appointed GALs that did not do what they are required by state law, not included us in any of the investigation, been bias, making recommendations based on one side and supported my son being ripped away from a healthy household and all of his siblings and maternal family who have been extremely close and placed him with our abuser and man who raped ,beat me and held me hostage along with abusing my son.
>
> — (DEMETRICE) INEZ

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Completely and utterly destroyed me my kids and all of our hopes, dreams, milestones, and moments. They stole everything from us.

— ERIC

It's destroyed the Fabric of innocence for Children and Families in a Country that's supposed to protect it.

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> — KELLY

> It has completely destroyed our entire lives. My long standing business of over 40 years was forced to shut down. We became homeless with no help. My other children are psychologically damaged by severing their bond with their sister.
>
> — ELECTRA

> Family court ripped my family apart. My child went from a loving family to being abused and miserable. Her smile that was once bright and happy has been stripped for tears and a hard frown. I keep asking, how is it I had her all her life and there was never an issue but now I'm an unfit parent? I have 6 kids total. She is number 5, why would I hurt her? And I had a second child by him and he is allowed to say he doesn't want her and yall are ok with that? Yall aren't saying I'm unfit for my other children, why just her? My own kids will tell you how much they love and appreciate me as their mother. The courts didnt just take her from me, they took her from her siblings even the one she shares a mom and dad with for what? Money?
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Hey, it ripped us apart. Manipulating my kids to turn against me.Also separated my children two and one home to another with no visitation for the siblings
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> She has destroyed my children’s safety and security to avoid acknowledging she made a mistake.
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I asked for a divorce so that I could get at least half of my house or half of my children or half of my 401(k) or half of my car or half of my motorcycle instead they took everything now I'm homeless carless I work at 9 to 5 and I haven't seen my kids since I met Mr. Whitbeck.

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This system has ripped me away from my child with no evidence presented other than the childs father's word.

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— MICHAEL

Broke my children right caused them mental abuse and caused them years of trauma. Broke my constitutional right caused me trauma. Helped the other party to to cause them mental and physical abuse. Both of my children have been put in situations that have caused them mental and physical abuse and I have 911 calls to prove this coming from their home. Helping the other party with parental alienation.

— KATHRYN

Emotional abuse in a time of need . Destroyed my family and home and myself every joy in my wonderful life is gone. They killed my soul and I'm alone in the world completely..

— AARAH

My sister lost her children for staying in an abusive relationship. I lost mine for leaving. As women, there was no path that led to protection.

— SARA

The corruption in our judicial system cost me the ability to provide the life my children deserved on a regular basis and often the loss of stable, structured, nurturing time together. My experience is minor compared to many others, yet it matters and is an indicator of a huge problem with the industry. The emotional toll on my kids of recognizing the discrepancy in our lifestyles; and realizing the injustice on their own has tainted their view of their father and their relationship with him and the system itself.

— VALARIE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Mentally destroyed a child. He will never recover from being taken away from his Mom and 4 years old and given to a Dad that physically and mentally abused him.
>
> — MCKENZIE

> This system has destroyed the loving relationship with our son. Also they have caused my son serious trauma and us severe trauma, that i know is going to take years to heal from. And quite literally changed the coarse of my family for the worst.
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> — DUSTIN

> This system has failed my young daughter and myself, “time always tells the truth” a has clearly proven that corruption is prominent and rampant. This system has proven that is it more profitable to be unlawful and corrupt vs upholding or practicing lawfully to protect children and parents from the abusive individuals that are somehow very able to exploit the power in system that seems to side with child trafficking rather to honor the sworn oath these individuals have taken which has proven to mean nothing anymore because these individuals ability to look away and allowing a child to be abused say it all.
>
> — EARL

> We have been incredibly traumatized and devastated by what has occurred over the past 2 1/2 years. We miss our children and the moments we’re being prohibited from sharing with them every single day.
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— CHRIS

Destroyed me financially, caused defamation of my status as a mother, caused me to develop cptsd, anxiety and more. Same for my child.

— JULIE

Shattered my dreams of motherhood.

— LARESHEA

They have broken us. They have traumatize everyone involved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system turned the people I love into evidence, reduced my motherhood to litigation, and left my children, the family they were separated from, and me to carry the consequences and find our own way toward healing, if we ever can.

— WHITNEY

It has literally bankrupt me, I had to walk away or become homeless. My children beg to live with me and continue to report the same instances of neglect and abuse they have the entire time.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken my entire life and made me suicidal

— LOREN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Lack of accountability. Allowed continued harassment as per the GAL “he’s still the father”.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Fairfax county in Virginia is a pro dad county. The moms have no rights

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has truly destroyed our lives, I went there for protection. That was the worse decision I could have made

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

retaliation over contested iep had to sell our home to afford attorney ..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The anti family court system is absolutely diabolical and corrupt. Children are trafficked to the parent with the most money. This experience has absolutely devestated myself and my children and we will never be the same.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Quick and GAL Jamison Raspberry together ruined my child’s life. She’s now neglected severely and there’s no way to fix it without spending $40,000 more because they’re incompetent and should not be in the position they are. This is a circus court that gave my ex who is a controlling abuser full custody of my young child that now suffers as a result of their negligence to do their job. It’s pure insanity what goes on there in VB J&D they in a way helped my abuser. Continue to abuse me I now have CPTSD from it and it’s actually caused my whole family to be hurting for my child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Robed me of time and money. My children are forever damaged. Worst mistake to get married. Ruined me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Caused PTSD for me, and my family. It has caused tremendous and traumatic damage to myself and my fiancé that is going to take years to fix. Caused severe depression in our 11 year old. Caused serious strain on our relationships when we were all so close and this cause was malicious.

— MARISSA

I survived and protected my child from being nearly killed by his father mishandling a firearm while inebriated in our home. Now they call me a liar and mentally ill and now his dad filed a false abuse case to take him away completely

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This corrupt system has destroyed us as a family unit and human beings. We have been demoralized and tormented in the most inhumane ways and will never be the same again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

the system that was supposed to protect our children has instead been weaponized agaainst us- worker with conflicting interests, medical information leaked.

— NICHOLE

Destroyed it broke us

— JESSICA

Removed my son under false allocations. Allowed a criminal to have sole custody of my son without reasonable visitation

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely ruined our family. Devastated us. I still have days where I don't know if I'll survive this.

— MCKENZI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Roanoke City CPS and family court shadder my whole life drove a wedge between me and my oldest daughter because they threatened that if she was to help me figure out how they were taking her siblings that they weren't going to return her youngest son either!!!
>
> — TRACEY

> The system ended my family and took everything from my life.
>
> — HAYLEY

> It feels like your house is burning down and being forced to save your child with your hands tied behind your back.
>
> — JENNIFER

> The system has destroyed my family, personal relationships and professional reputation
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The family court system has utterly destroyed the children's mental and emotional well being, creating anxiety chaos and feelings of compromised safety. Separation between parents and children have irreversibly impacted both the mental emotional and physical health, comprising trust in the government while simultaneously crippling our family regarding finances and overall health/wellness.
>
> — AMY

> I just want awareness and justice & people need to know what CPS actually does and for financial gain also there is no one above them all complaints go through their office so obviously it's almost impossible no fair fight
>
> — CRYSTAL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The custody evaluator failed to consider key evidence of psychological abuse and coercive control by my ex-husband, dismissed my concerns, and did not take meaningful steps to protect my children. Despite presenting herself as understanding and supportive, her unprofessional conduct and final recommendation of 50/50 custody left me feeling misled, unprotected, and harmed by a process I trusted to prioritize my children's well-being.

— CAROLINE

Unfair trial, that resulted in changes over concerns and allegations, that weren't proven.

— BRITTANY

Total destruction to a beautiful healthy thriving family

— BEATRICE

Roanoke Family court Hillary Griffith and Kelli Boyer has caused severe emotional disturbance in our six-year-old son and the whole court proceedings. Are you traumatized, find the domestic violence abuse? They have storm years away, sound. I family being able to live happy. Normal lives. I created a deep mistrust, and I opened the experience to have correct. The family court systems are how dangerous they are. And how jach's whoa? With no oversight abuse that power

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was fighting a system i was never meant to win, at my child's peril.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have proven that they do not want strong fathers. They want to break you and then say you are a deadbeat.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed everything!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Anonymous, Chesterfield/Colonial Heights, Virginia

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Never ever sign or notorized any document giving someone authority to take care of your child without a return date that you have money to fight for in court. Do not trust anyone to help you that says they wil when they will not meet with you in person and do not trust you g adult children to help you if they are resentful. Tape record all conversations, only use email to communicate with CPS.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court has destroyed my relationship with my daughter and made it impossible for me to see her. It financially destroyed me and made it impossible for me to pay support and live.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is intentionally destroying family units for monetary. It has made each member of my family living in a constant survival state.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost contact with my daughter due to her being put with her coercive controling father. She is continuing to struggle with her identity, emotional regulation, and mental health. My only concern is seeing her stable and happy.

— CHRISTIN

We went into family court seeking consistency and careful consideration of our concerns. Instead, our family left with trauma that has changed each of us and may never fully heal.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Didn't get treatment for one child putting her life at risk

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This has destroyed any trust my little girl has in her daddy. She is so addicted to phone/ tablet after she returned and no longer prays when before she was on fire for Christ.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Told a bunch of lies and harmed the child

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Falls ligation by wife, pregnant with another man's baby post affair used allegation to gain house and Custer of children 6 months after she left and allegations made as she would have found out pregnant.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It destabilized my children's sense of safety and well-being while dismantling the financial and life structure I had built over decades to protect them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has taken a child with documented sexual and physical abuse, put him back with his abuser and taken me the protective parent out of his life. Allowing the abuser and the LCSW who has an inappropriate relationship with the father, and made it so that they get to decide when I see my son. I have to pay the LCSW $100 an hour for visitation, while she reads over the visitation notes in court and fabricates what happens/happened during that visit.. when she states that visitation didn't go well, or after taking a "clinical" look she thinks that I shouldn't have anything but supervised visits at her facility where she gets paid.

— SIDNEY

Instead of protecting my family during a vulnerable custody matter, this system allowed my trust, finances, and relationship with my child to be placed at risk while I was billed heavily and left fighting for accountability. It turned a parent seeking help into a consumer of expensive legal harm, with little meaningful protection or recourse

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Completely broken me inside and out from the constant weight of stress placed on me at a very vulnerable time in my life being I was a stay at home mother before this. My children are suffering physically and emotionally as well with constant infections or injuries while I've been away. They are 2 and a 1/2 and 1. Can't tell mom. Dad doesn't let me speak to them. I am homeless. I am unemployed.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system is rigged
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> This system has denied my children access fair access to their mother & awarded full custody to a previously uninvolved father who has worked tirelessly to erase my existence and deny my contributions while simultaneously stripping me of my home; financisl resources; all marital income & all other resources.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> In Bedford J&DR, fatherhood is a purchase, not a right. Mother's statements are taken as fact and father is guilty until proven innocent. It's clear the Bedford J&DR courts "best interest standard" is not about the child, but about the title IV D funding.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Our family was torn apart by allegations and hearsay before our evidence was ever fully heard. Logan lost stability, Brittany lost time with her child, and we lost our home, finances, and peace while trying to fight a system that felt decided before we even walked into court.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Had to spend 60k plus in prolonged litigation trying to prove my innocence. We gave all been effected emotionally. PTSD, child alienation over controlling ex.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The court system's terrifying disregard for my family's safety has trapped us in a never-ending hell of harassment and fear. It has cost us absolutely everything, destroying a well-paying career and leaving us in debt and barely making it, but I will still spend every single breath fighting for my kids
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Well it brought you here
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Awarded my abusive, suicidal husband unsupervised visitation with our son during our separation against the testimony of the supervised visitation agent. Ignored a protective order and continued violations of that order. Would not grant emergency hearings when GAL discovered unfit conditions in my abusive husbands living arrangements and behavior. Granted me physical custody but would not implement or enforce child support.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Took sole legal custody-and now 50/50. 5 years in court -filed full custody 3x as punishment- his atty hired used/paid psychologists to say things that they routinely work with - said he wouldn't stop until I have no custody left- I had 300+ pieces of evidence & testimony that was ignored and his behavior dismissed.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have been robbed of time I can never get back with my daughter. Mother has manipulated a for-profit system to alienate me completely. The fight to restore our time together has cost life energy I can't quantify.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

97 full approved Virginia comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Virginia report comes from Virginia respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Virginia — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 154 Virginia families reporting here are not the universe of Virginia families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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